

OnePlus Nord CE 3 Lite 5G

Gets more than just the price right

The Nord CE 3 Lite 5G, which despite being similar to the last generation CE 2 Lite in some areas, is a decent upgrade on the device. Read our review to find out if it's worth your money.

DESIGN AND DISPLAY

The Nord CE 3 Lite has a clean boxy design. The build quality of the phone is such that it actually ends up looking quite premium. From the in-hand feel of the phone to how the back panel looks and the feedback of the physical buttons on the side of the device, there's nothing not to like about the OnePlus Nord CE 3 Lite 5G's design. Except, of course, for the massive lens enclosures at the back. There's little to complain about the display also. While it's not the brightest, the most colour accurate or the most vibrant of panels you'd find on the phone in the segment, it's good for watching movies and shows and offers decent colour accuracy, contrast ratios, and a typical peak brightness of 535 nits to help the panel reproduce accurate visuals not only inside a dark room but also when you're on the move and using the phone's panel that's exposed to harsh sunlight. It can handle fast refresh rates up to 120Hz across 6 different stops -- between 30 to 120Hz.

PERFORMANCE AND BATTERY

Interestingly, it's also the same chip that we had on the OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite 5G. So performance here is pretty much the same that we saw on last year's affordable Nord phone. In our time with the device, we generally faced minimal lags and stutters in our regular usage. Benchmarks also threw up decent results, with the CPU Throttling test showing the phone only throttling to 83 per cent of its peak performance after 15 minutes, which is not bad for a sub-20K phone. Other benchmarks like AnTuTu and Geekbench



also performed decently well on the phone, with scores just about on par with competing devices. Asphalt 9 Legends and CoD: Mobile both run at high graphics and high frame rate settings on the device. Overall, gaming was good on the OnePlus Nord CE 3 Lite 5G. In terms of user experience, this UI offers all that you want from a mid-range phone and keeps things simple and clean while doing so. Battery performance is good on the device. Thanks to the energy-efficient chipset and software, the device is quite efficient with battery management in day-to-day use. We easily got a day's use for moderate use. Benchmark numbers were also decent, with the video loop test for the device clocking in at 670 minutes. And even when the battery ran out of charge, we could charge it back to the brim in about 40 minutes. This again is good if you're looking for a phone that doesn't keep you hooked to the wall socket for extended periods during the day.

CAMERAS

The primary lens ensures the phone

gets an overall good rating in the camera department. It clicks well-detailed shots with a good amount of detail and colour accuracy thanks to the supporting computational algorithm for the camera module. In the daytime, it pulls plenty of detail and lets shots shine with good dynamic range. Even in low light, the results are good as the primary lens on the Nord CE 3 Lite 5G manages to pull in plenty of light and also detail. There is little noise and the shutter speed is also decent in low light. There's also a 16MP selfie shooter that's been given some extra tricks up its sleeve courtesy of the camera software on the phone. As such, you get features like an upgraded Portrait mode for selfies which clicks good shots with accurate skin tones.

VERDICT

This is a well-rounded device, which may not stand out from the crowd, but it does hold its own against the competition when it comes to performance in key areas. Cameras and battery are the standout features here and deserve a call out from us, but even the general performance and design of the device are pretty good and are good enough to warrant a buying recommendation from us. The only matter of concern is if the device's chipset, the Snapdragon 695 SoC will be able to hold its own in years to come and leaving it a bit too underpowered in front of phones that may launch in a few months.

—Sushant Talwar

SPECIFICATIONS

Display Size: 17.07 centimeters (6.72 inches) | Resolution: 2400 x 1080 pixels 391ppi | Aspect Ratio: 20:9 | Refresh Rate: 120Hz | Type: LCD | Touch Response Rate: 240Hz | CPU: Qualcomm® Snapdragon™ 695 5G | GPU: Adreno 619 | RAM: 8GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128GB/256GB UFS2.2 | Battery: 5000mAh (non-removable) | Rear Camera: Macro: 2 MP, f/2.4; Main Camera: 108 MP, f/1.7; Depth-assist Camera: 2 MP, f/2.4 | Front Camera - 16 MP, f/2.4

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